

Nothing Phone 3a Pro

A Phone That Dares to Be Different (and Mostly Succeeds)

Until last year, the mid-range smartphone segment had some conventional looks and good enough hardware, but then Nothing entered the market with the Phone 2a (review). The aim was straightforward: to provide a one-of-a-kind design and interesting concept to play with, and it worked really well for them. After the success of Phone 2a, which sold over 100k in the first 24 hours of launch, the company expanded into the entry-level range with its sub-brand CMF.

In 2025, the first product from Nothing is the successor to the Phone 2a and Phone 2a Plus, but there's a catch. While you can call the Phone 3a, a direct successor, the company seems to have done away with the Plus branding and instead this year we have the Phone 3a Pro, a new iteration in its 'a' series priced at Rs 29,999. I know the question you all have in your mind—does the Phone 3a Pro provide an experience comparable to a 'Pro' phone?

DESIGN

The first thing you will notice is a big, protruding camera bump with an asymmetrical triple camera setup, a big upgrade over the dual camera setup offered with the Phone 2a. While it is obvious that the device needed some "extra" space to fit the periscope lens, it does have some trade-offs. When you hold the device, you will find the weight distribution somewhat off, making one-handed use slightly uncomfortable. You might find yourself adjusting your grip more often than usual, unlike the Google Pixels and Vivo X series phones. Plus, placing it on a table isn't the most reassuring experience. I found placing it

₹29,999



face-down much better and maybe Nothing wants you to do just that to give way for the LED light effects.

Nothing has retained the Glyph interface which is my favourite aspect of the device with some unique use cases, and the back glass is also covered in Panda glass, giving the phone a more premium look and an improved in-hand feel. There's also a new button, just below the power button, dedicated to activating the Essential Space feature, which we'll discuss later in the review. In terms of durability, Nothing has offered a less durable Panda Glass protection, compared to the Gorilla Glass. The device also gets an IP64 certification, meaning it can only handle some water splashes.

DISPLAY

The Nothing Phone 3a Pro sports a 6.77-inch Full HD+ AMOLED panel with Panda Glass protection and a 120Hz adaptive refresh rate. The display feels buttery smooth and vibrant with punchy yet accurate colours. Interestingly, Nothing claims the display can reach 800 nits in manual mode and 1,300 nits in auto-brightness mode, but our testing showed even better results where the display hit 1,327 nits in manual mode and 2,250 nits in adaptive mode. This means you get better visibility, especially outdoors or under direct sunlight.

Additionally, the display on the 3a Pro features 10-bit colour depth (1.07 billion colours) and HDR10+ support, making OTT streaming and video playback a treat. In our display test using Calman to determine the colour accuracy, the 3a Pro's display got an average delta E of 1.5 in the Standard colour profile, which means that you can rest assured of accurate colours on this screen. The display offers a crisp and immersive experience during your Netflix binge-watching sessions.

PERFORMANCE

The Nothing Phone 3a Pro and its sibling the Phone 3a, is powered by the Snapdragon 7s Gen 3 chipset. In the AnTuTu benchmark, the Phone 3a scored 790,600, while the Phone 3a Pro managed 822,130, a marginal difference that's unlikely to impact real-world usage.

Similarly, in Geekbench tests, the Phone 3a scored 1,158 (single-core) and 3,305 (multi-core). In contrast, the Phone 3a Pro scored 1,169 (single-core) and 3,291 (multi-core)—again, no significant gap. Even the read/write speeds and PC Mark Battery Life scores are practically the same. In the CPU throttling test, the Phone 3a witnessed a 7 percent drop while the Phone 3a Pro witnessed a 6 percent drop, excelling in the extreme workload test.

However, I believe Nothing could have opted for the Snapdragon 7+ Gen 2 chipset to better justify the "Pro" branding. While the Snapdragon 7s Gen 3 is well-optimised on the phone,